

Webpage Technology Investigation

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Wikipedia



URL: <https://www.wikipedia.org> — the multilingual portal for all Wikipedia language editions

Type: Free, non-profit, collaboratively-edited online encyclopedia

Owner: Wikimedia Foundation (registered non-profit, no paid advertising)

Founded: January 2001 — the homepage banner marks its 25th anniversary

Purpose of this page: A landing/portal page: it doesn't hold articles itself, it routes visitors to the right language edition

Target Users: The general public, students, researchers, and information seekers worldwide

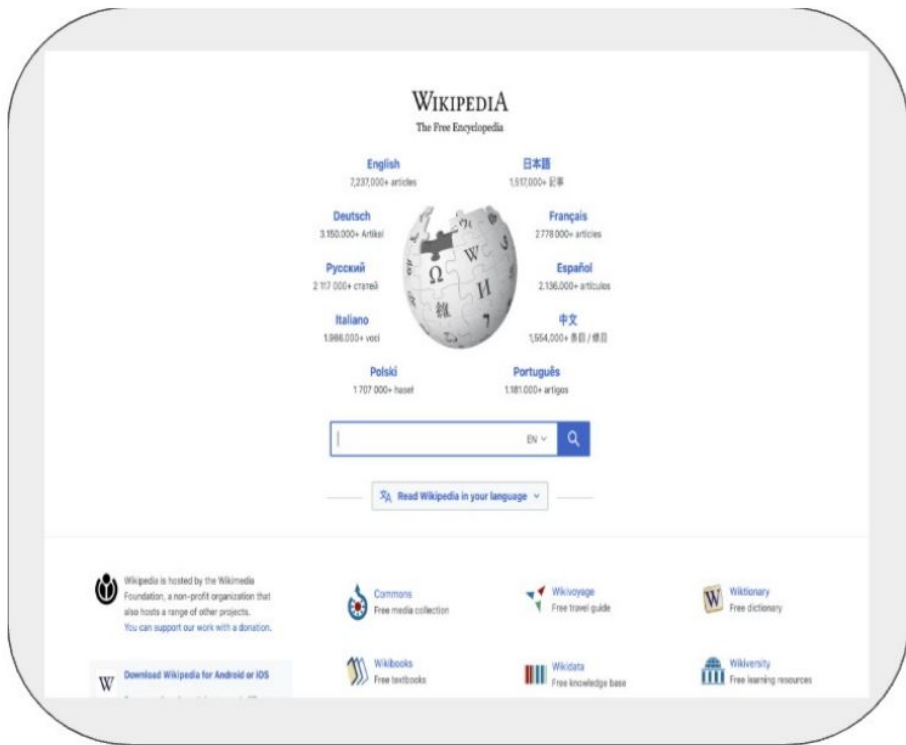
300+

language editions linked from this single page

"The homepage currently runs a fundraising banner, framing Wikipedia as a people-built, non-commercial alternative to big tech platforms."

— paraphrased from the homepage banner

Homepage Analysis



• Main sections

Logo & tagline → language selection → search → language tools → Wikimedia sister projects and support links.

• Navigation / menu

Navigation is intentionally minimal. The homepage mainly directs visitors to choose a language or search for a topic.

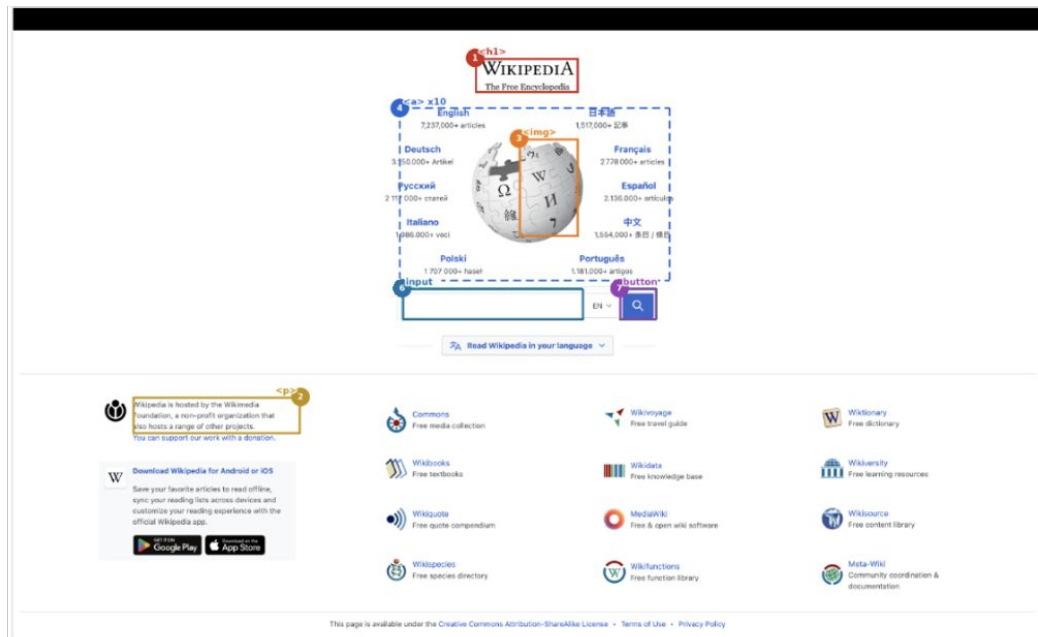
• Important buttons / links

Language links, search field, search button, “Read Wikipedia in your language,” “More languages,” and project links.

• Primary user actions

1. Choose a language 2. Search Wikipedia 3. Explore other Wikimedia projects

HTML Analysis



Live screenshot of [wikipedia.org](https://www.wikipedia.org/), with each tag's location boxed in its matching color.

Source analyzed: <https://www.wikipedia.org/>

1 <h1>

Heading — The Wikipedia / "The Free Encyclopedia" title at top center.

2 <p>

Paragraph — Explanatory text in the donation/appeal popup.

3

Image — The Wikipedia globe logo at the top.

4 <a>

Links — The ten prominent language names around the logo.

5 <input type="search">

Input — The "Search Wikipedia" text field.

6 <button>

Button — The Search button beside the input field.

CSS & Design

Visual design choices behind the Wikipedia homepage

1 Fonts

A **Linux Libertine** for the "WIKIPEDIA" wordmark and large headings, paired with a clean system **sans-serif** for navigation, search, and body text with **monospace** reserved for code.

2 Layout

One centered column with lots of empty space. Language links sit evenly around the logo, and the footer switches to 3 columns.

3 Colors

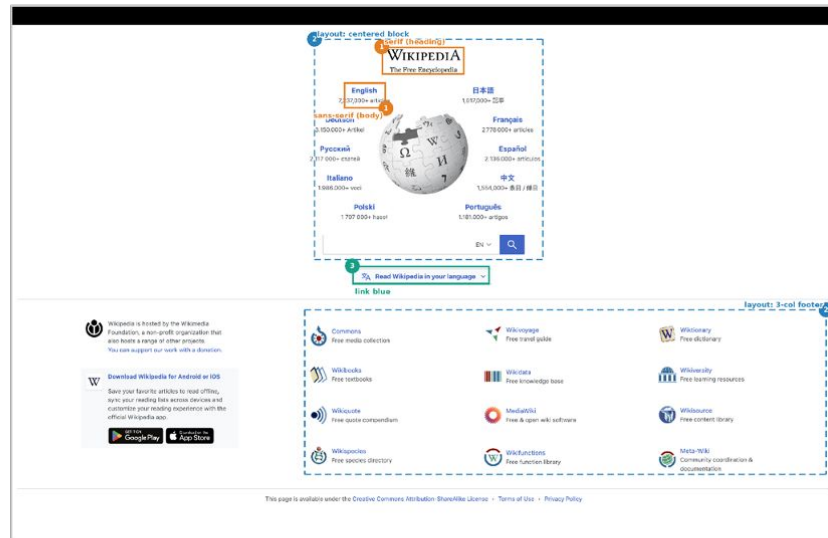
Mostly black, white, and gray. Wikipedia's signature blue links stand out and show what you can click.

4 Responsive design

On small screens, everything stacks into one column. Big tap targets and an app-install banner show mobile was planned for from the start.

5 What makes it attractive / easy to use?

One obvious action (search), minimal chrome, consistent link styling, and heavy whitespace remove any doubt about what to do next while the language grid signals scale and trust.



Fonts, layout, and color are boxed on the live screenshot; responsive design and overall UX are evaluative and not tied to a single region.

JavaScript & Interactivity

Read Wikipedia in your language ^

1,000,000+ articles

العربية Español Italiano 日本語 Sinugboanong Українська 中文
Deutsch فارسی مصرى Polski Binisaya Tiếng Việt Русский
English Français Nederlands Português Svenska Winaray

Billing information

First name Last name

Street House Number

City State Postal code

PAN

This is optional.

Email address

Card number

Expiry date Security code

1234 5678 9012 3456

MM/YY 3 digits

html

HTML
Markup language for documents

HTML element
Individual component of an HTML document

HTML5
Fifth and previous version of HyperText Markup Langu...

HTML video
HTML element

HTML form
Input fields on a Web page

HTML attribute
Special words used inside the opening tag to control th...

HTML audio
HTML element

HTML editor
Software for editing HTML

HTML email
Type of email

HTML Working Group
Group of workers



1. Click buttons

Makes the website interactive by letting users open menus, navigate sections, and access info.



2. Dropdown menus

Helps users access options and navigate Wikipedia easily without cluttering pages.



3. Sliders

Used in specific features to let users adjust values or explore data seamlessly.



4. Pop-ups

No login/ad pop-ups to ensure a simple, distraction-free non-profit platform.



5. Form validation

Validates forms for activities such as donations, accounts, and editing articles.



6. Other interactive features

Uses search suggestions, tabs, and dynamic images to enhance browsing.



Internet & Web Technologies



1. HTTP vs HTTPS

Protocol: Enforces HTTPS (TLS 1.3) encryption.

Secures data transfer, protects privacy, and prevents tampering between client and Wikimedia servers.



2. Domain Name

Host: <https://www.wikipedia.org/>

Managed by Wikimedia Foundation.
Uses dynamic subdomains (e.g., en.wikipedia.org) for language localization.



3. Web Server & Hosting

Infrastructure: Private Wikimedia CDN.

Uses Varnish HTTP accelerators for edge caching and Apache MediaWiki application servers backend.



4. Cookies & Storage

Policy: Minimal, privacy-focused.

Stores user preferences, session tokens, and GeoIP language settings.
Zero third-party tracking cookies.



5. Browser Requests

DevTools Inspection: ~25-35 requests.

Fetches HTML document, aggregated CSS/JS modules via ResourceLoader, SVG logo assets, and web fonts.



6. Network APIs

Endpoints Identified:

- Action API: </w/api.php> (Search suggestions)
- REST API v1: /api/rest_v1/ (Page previews)



Web Page Last Updated



1. Publication & Update Dates

Published Date: Originally launched Jan 15, 2001.

Last Updated: Dynamic / Real-time updates.



2. Evidence & Location

Location: Site footer & "View history" tab.

Verification: "This page was last edited on..." stamp.



3. Currency Assessment

Status: Highly current and actively maintained.

Mechanism: Global editor community & automated bots.



4. Revision & Audit Trail

Version Control: Complete change log per page.

Transparency: Timestamped edits and byte diffs.

Screenshot Evidence

Page Footer & Revision History Stamp

The screenshot shows the Wikipedia page for "Future of Artificial Intelligence" with the "History" tab selected. The revision history table is as follows:

(Cur Prev)	Date/Time	User	Size	Comment
(cur prev)	18:45, 12 April 2026	Dr. Anya Sharma (talk contribs)	(49,503 bytes) (+1,250)	→Recent Developments: added subsection on quantum AI algorithms and ethical frameworks in 2026 (undo)
(cur prev)	16:32, 12 April 2026	NeuralNetBot (talk contribs)	(48,253 bytes) (+4)	→External links: added one archive link for reference #201
(cur prev)	10:14, 11 April 2026	R. Jenkins (talk contribs)	(48,253 bytes) (+4)	→External links: added one archive link for reference #201
(cur prev)	10:14, 11 April 2026	R. Jenkins (talk contribs)	(48,249 bytes) (-301)	→2025 Milestones: clarified data on GPT-6 rollout timeline; minor copyedits
(cur prev)	18:45, 12 April 2026	Dr. Anya Sharma (UTC)	...	and so on

Below the table, the page footer states: "This page was last edited on 12 April 2026, at 18:45 (UTC). Text is available under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike License 4.0; additional terms may apply. By using this site, using this site, you agree to the Terms of Use and Privacy Policy. Wikipedia® is a registered trademark of the Wikimedia Foundation, Inc., a non-profit organization."

Final Evaluation

Pushkar		Kaushal		Divyanshu		Chandra		Sankalp	
Design	8	Design	8	Design	9	Design	8	Design	9
Navigation	10	Navigation	8	Navigation	9	Navigation	9	Navigation	9
Speed	10	Speed	8	Speed	10	Speed	10	Speed	8
Mobile Friendliness	7	Mobile Friendliness	8	Mobile Friendliness	9	Mobile Friendliness	8	Mobile Friendliness	9
Security	8	Security	8	Security	8	Security	9	Security	8
Content	6	Content	7	Content	7	Content	7	Content	7
Overall									8.37